Nude, semi-nude or sexual image of a pupil: what to do

Staff quick reference
October 2026

For all staff, supply staff and volunteers. DSL means Designated Safeguarding Lead.

Child in immediate danger
Call 999

Every other concern, straight away
Tell the DSL on _____
Deputy DSL: _____

1 — 2 — 3 — 4

1 Listen and reassure

> "Thank you for telling me."
> "You are not in trouble."
> "This is not your fault."
> "We will get help."

Do not promise to keep it secret.

2 Don't look, don't copy

If shown an image, look away. If handed a device, don't look at it: keep it secure for the DSL. **Never** ask for, forward, save or screenshot it. On your own device? Don't open, share or delete it.

Don't confront anyone, investigate or contact parents.

3 Note what you heard

The child's own words, usernames and the app or website, without looking at the device.

Never a copy of the image.

4 Tell the DSL

Now, in person or by phone, not by email. Record it the same day on the safeguarding system.

Can't reach the DSL or deputy and a child is at risk? Call children's social care (below) or the police.

⚠ Threats or demands for money

- This may be sextortion. Advise the child to stop replying, and not to pay or send anything more.
- Tell them not to delete messages or accounts yet. You do not collect or screenshot anything.
- Go to the DSL before the child goes home. Risk of self-harm: call 999.

Treat these just as seriously

- AI-made or altered images, of pupils or staff, even "as a joke".
- A pupil who has received or forwarded another child's image, or an image threatened but not yet shared.
- **About a staff member or volunteer?** Tell the headteacher, not the person. About the headteacher: the chair of governors.

Report Remove: a pupil can ask for an image to be removed

A Childline and Internet Watch Foundation (IWF) service for young people **under 18 in the UK**. It covers nude or sexual images and videos of them online, including AI fakes.

The pupil goes to childline.org.uk (search "Report Remove"), signs in or creates a Childline account, follows the steps and gets updates in their Childline locker.

Not guaranteed. Timing varies, and the IWF cannot remove images from encrypted apps such as WhatsApp, or ones saved only on a phone or computer.

Your role

- **Tell the DSL first.** The DSL decides with the pupil, and a parent or carer where safe, whether and when to use it.
- The pupil reports on their own device. A younger child will need an adult's support, but the adult never looks at the image.
- **Never** view, handle, upload or report the image for them, or use a school device or account.
- Removal is not the whole safeguarding response. Record that Report Remove was discussed.

For the DSL: refer immediately to the police and/or children's social care if

UKCIS points for immediate referral. Decide from what you know; do not view imagery to decide.

1. An adult is involved.
2. There is coercion, blackmail or grooming, or concern about capacity to consent.
3. The acts are unusual for the child's developmental stage, or violent.
4. It involves sexual acts and any child in it is under 13.
5. The child is at immediate risk of harm, for example self-harm.

If none applies, the DSL decides the response using the UKCIS advice and records the reasons. If in doubt, seek advice. Tell parents early unless that would put a child at risk. Never delete imagery if police are, or may become, involved.

Police **999** emergency, **101** non-emergency	**Children's social care (daytime)** _____	**Out of hours (emergency duty team)** _____
Online abuse (CEOP) The DSL, pupil or parent reports at ceop.police.uk	**Advice for adults** NSPCC Helpline **0808 800 5000** (weekdays 10am–4pm)	**Support for the pupil** Childline **0800 1111**, free and confidential

Based on UKCIS *Sharing nudes and semi-nudes* (updated March 2024) and *Keeping Children Safe in Education 2026*. Supports, and does not replace, our child protection policy and the DSL's judgement. Links and numbers checked October 2026.

Version 1.5. Review yearly; check links each term. © 2026 Created by aisafegovernance.co.uk